

- ▶ Two individual hackers or teams/groups of hackers found vulnerabilities in different systems at the same time.
- ▶ Both the groups had malicious intent.
- ▶ Both hacker groups knew about each other and communicated with each other for the plan to attack.
- ▶ None of them launched the attack on individual basis.

Even if one of the conditions did not match two systems cannot be brought down at the same time. Add to this mix the fact that various companies involved in providing the hardware and software which constitute such systems keep researching on their ends as well.

This boils down the effects of cyber-terrorism to its bare bones - the narrow definition which includes the use of viruses and other malware. The target can be either random or specific group of computers. In most cases the viruses are spread out in the wild which makes the target random. Antivirus companies are at work to counter those and virus attacks in general have always been prevented until now. Additionally Microsoft has been working on its end too to provide more security to its users. We cannot talk about Mac and Linux for there hardly are any viruses for them and the fact that they constitute very small percentage of computer users makes them a weak spot for being targeted by cyber-terrorists (or hackers). Thus, in the public domain the cyber-terrorism has less chances to happen as well.

Let's summarize this entire chapter. We started off with the broadest definition possible for cyber terrorism. Then we introduced to you the narrow definition and widened our view towards what could happen in the name cyber terrorism area and yet again cancelled the possibilities of each one of them. What conclusion can be drawn in the end? Well, the fact is - the narrow definition of mere use of viruses and malware does exist to a fair extent but cannot be labelled as 'terrorism' in its own right as it cannot cause a havoc. However, beyond that point, there are possibilities and those cannot be denied. Though there have not been many cases of attacks on critical networks, there are chances. There have been events of takedown and website defacements to spark off wild imaginations of computers being responsible for a widespread mayhem. The case we left off was "targeting specific group of computers intentionally for attack" which we would cover in the next chapter as they are not acts of 'terrorism', but of 'war' by one group on another. 